

PELICAN BAY POLICE DEPARTMENT
HOMICIDE DIVISION — EIGHTH DISTRICT

715 South Broad Avenue, New Orleans, LA 70119
(504) 658-6080

SUSPECT INTERVIEW — TRAVIS BELL

Case No.: PBPB-2025-088142 | Document No.: 16

Suspect:	TRAVIS BELL
Race/Sex/DOB:	M/W, March 8, 1994 (Age 31)
Address:	1104 St. Claude Avenue, New Orleans, LA 70117
Employment:	HVAC Technician, Crescent City Cooling LLC
Interview Date:	October 4, 2025
Interview Time:	11:00 AM – 11:38 AM
Location:	PBPB Eighth District Station, Interview Room 2
Miranda Advisory:	READ AND ACKNOWLEDGED — 11:00 AM
Interviewing Detectives:	Det. Renee Broussard #1887 / Det. Charles Lemaire #2019
Case Number:	PBPB-2025-088142

[BEGIN INTERVIEW TRANSCRIPT — CONDENSED]

BROUSSARD: Travis, let's talk about last night. Were you at The Rusty Anchor?

BELL: Yeah. Me, Derek, and Ryan went out. Nothing unusual.

BROUSSARD: Did you see any altercation involving Derek and another man?

BELL: Derek had some words with a guy. It was nothing. Typical bar stuff.

BROUSSARD: Were you involved in those words?

BELL: I was standing near Derek. I wasn't really in it.

BROUSSARD: A witness says you said 'We'll finish this outside' to the man Derek was arguing with. Did you say that?

BELL: [pause] I don't remember saying that. Maybe I said something, I was drinking. It didn't mean anything.

BROUSSARD: The man you were arguing with was found beaten to death in the alley behind the bar. At approximately the time you were back there.

BELL: Whoa, hold on. I didn't beat anyone. I left early. I was home by one.

BROUSSARD: The bar camera shows you leaving through the back door at 1:18 AM, with Derek and Ryan. Not alone. Not at 1 AM.

BELL: Cameras can be wrong. I left early.

BROUSSARD: Travis, what happened to your right hand?

BELL: I fell. I slipped on the street, caught myself on a curb.

BROUSSARD: The laceration pattern on your knuckles is consistent with striking a person, not a fall. A fall typically shows palm abrasions. You have knuckle impact bruising.

BELL: I want a lawyer right now. We're done.

BROUSSARD: Interview suspended at 11:38 AM. Suspect invoked right to counsel.

[END INTERVIEW]

DETECTIVE NOTE: Bell's claim of leaving at 1 AM is directly contradicted by indoor surveillance. His denial of the verbal threat 'We'll finish this outside' is non-credible given witness corroboration. His explanation for the knuckle laceration is inconsistent with the injury pattern documented by PBPB medical staff. Bell's early invocation of counsel (38 minutes into interview) is notable. His text to Fontenot at 2:48 AM ('Don't say anything') demonstrates consciousness of guilt.

Invocation of Counsel: 11:38 AM — interview terminated.

Detective Signature: _____ Renee Broussard #1887